

SERVING PLAN 3 SERVING PLAN

Saucy Meatball Sliders

with Classic Caesar Salad

We adore sliders, the crowd-pleasing miniature version of hamburgers that can be eaten in two hungry bites. In this Encore Recipe, our "burgers" are actually meatballs, made with creamy ricotta and a touch of marinara sauce to keep them light and moist. Piled onto toasted mini buns with a dusting of Parmesan, they're about to slide into your dinner hall of fame.

35–45 minutes 830 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 2 romaine hearts
- 2 lemons
- 1 clove garlic
- ½ cup breadcrumbs
- 4 ounces ricotta cheese
- 1 16-ounce jar marinara sauce, divided
- 1 pound ground beef, divided
- 9 brioche slider buns
- ½ teaspoon anchovy paste
- 2 ounces mayonnaise
- 1½ ounces grated Parmesan cheese

You'll need

- olive oil
- 1 egg
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- aluminum foil
- baking sheet
- 12" large pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Salt helps break down garlic and extract its natural juices. By repeatedly scraping down and pressing, you'll get a paste. Doing so makes for a smooth, flavorful addition to your dressing.

Incorporate meatball ingredients without overmixing. Using your hands to loosely pack each meatball ensures maximum juiciness.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Line a baking sheet with foil for Step 3. Halve **romaine** hearts lengthwise and rinse thoroughly, then thinly slice crosswise, discarding tough stems. Halve **lemons**. Mince **garlic** and sprinkle over **⅛ teaspoon salt**. Using a large knife, carefully scrape over mixture at a 45° angle, pressing down. Repeat until garlic is broken down and a paste forms (see recipe tip).



2. Form meatballs

In a large bowl, combine **breadcrumbs**, **1 tablespoon ricotta**, **1½ tablespoons marinara sauce**, **1 egg**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper**. Pat **beef** dry with paper towel. Reserve **a small handful of beef** on a small plate for making meat sauce; add **remaining beef** to bowl with meatball ingredients. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 9 equal meatballs, about 2 inches thick (see recipe tip). Save remaining ricotta for a snack (we love it on toast).



3. Bake meatballs

Place **meatballs** on prepared baking sheet, spacing apart as much as possible. Bake until slightly browned and cooked through, 15–18 minutes.



4. Cook meat sauce

While meatballs bake, heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large pan over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, add **reserved beef** and cook, breaking up, until browned, about 3 minutes. Add **remaining marinara sauce** and cook, stirring, until thickened, 4–5 minutes. Season with **⅛ teaspoon salt** and **pepper**. Remove pan from heat. Once baked, add **meatballs** to pan with sauce and turn to coat, reserving sheet for the next step.



5. Toast buns and make salad

Discard foil from baking sheet. Slice **buns** open horizontally and arrange cut-side up on baking sheet. Bake until toasted and light golden, 2–3 minutes. Meanwhile, in a large bowl, whisk together **anchovy paste**, **mayonnaise**, **2 tablespoons Parmesan**, **juice of 2 lemons**, and **garlic paste** until fully combined. Season with **⅛ teaspoon salt** and **pepper** as desired. Add **romaine** to bowl with dressing and toss to coat.



6. Plate meatball sliders

Divide **bun bottoms** among serving plates. Add **meatballs**, then a generous spoonful of **meat sauce**, then **remaining Parmesan**. Finish with **bun tops**. Serve **meatball sliders** with **classic Caesar salad** and dig in. (Using your hands for the sliders is highly encouraged!)

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